The Boston Globe

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THURSDAY, OCTOBER 15, 2026

Longtime Vt. governor faces a challenge

Polls see tightening race between Scott and progressive newcomer

By Paul Heintz
GLOBE STAFF

BURLINGTON, Vt. — Like many Democrats in this liberal state, Julie Filiberti has voted for Republican Governor Phil Scott several times over the years, reasoning that he was "a centrist" and "a nice guy."

But now, the 63-year-old paraeducator from Fairfax is asking herself a new question.

"Are we better off after 10 years under Phil Scott?" Filiberti said. "Things have been getting worse, and with more of the same, little tweaks are not going to make a difference."

Enough Vermonters appear to be coming to a similar conclusion that Scott is facing his toughest reelection test since winning his first two-year term in 2016.

Long regarded as the country's most popular governor, Scott won each of his last three races by more than 40 percentage points. But two recent polls show Democratic challenger Amanda Janoo, a political novice, narrowing the gap.

One suggested Scott was leading Janoo by just 10 percentage points. The other found Janoo actually ahead of Scott by 6 points. Both showed that for the first time, fewer than half of Vermonters approve of the incumbent's job performance.

Now some in Vermont are questioning whether Scott, a political moderate who is the last of the anti-Trump Republican governors, will withstand the "blue wave" threatening GOP candidates around the country, as well as a general discontent with incumbents.

"Phil Scott, as a Republican in

VERMONT, Page A10

'I didn't ever imagine that as a doctor I would be living paycheck-to-paycheck.'

CHRIS TORLONE, *a resident at Boston Medical Center*



PHOTOS BY DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

Chris Torlone and her husband have two sons, and the older one likes to play with his mother's stethoscope.

Becoming a doctor isn't paying off yet

Family struggles to get by on resident's $85,000

One in an occasional series exploring how the workers who make the Boston area the place that it is navigate the astronomical cost of living here.

By Dana Gerber
GLOBE STAFF

WICKED EXPEN$IVE

The worker: Chris Torlone, 33, is a third-year internal medicine resident at Boston Medical Center. She lives in the South End with her husband, their two sons — a nearly 2-year-old and a 3-month-old — and their dog, Banjo.

The career: Torlone, who grew up in Boxford, had what she calls a "nontraditional entrance into medicine."

After high school, she quickly dropped out of college and moved to Portland, Maine, working in coffee shops and restaurants and volunteering at Planned Parenthood. She made friends who were applying to nursing programs and decided to pursue a similar path, enrolling in a local college. There, a microbiology professor threw out the idea of medical school.

"As soon as he said it, I was like, 'Oh my God, why has this never occurred to me?' " she said. "I liked this idea of being a person in a scary situation who could make somebody feel less scared."

Plus, there was another, seemingly obvious benefit to a medical career.

"I was like, 'Wow, how cool would it be to not have

EXPENSIVE, Page A5



BPS calls for ban on student cellphones

Would also lock up other electronics all day

By Christopher Huffaker
GLOBE STAFF

Boston school officials are proposing a comprehensive bell-to-bell ban on all personal electronic devices next year that would prohibit students from using not just phones, but also laptops, tablets, smartwatches, and smart glasses.

The proposal, outlined in a memo to the School Committee Wednesday evening, would require students to lock up non-school-issued devices for the entire school day beginning in fall 2027.

School administrators said the ban was "grounded in research showing the negative impact of social media and constant screen exposure on adolescent mental health and focus," according to the three-page memo.

The push comes as a proposal to ban cellphones in all public schools in Massachusetts languishes in the Legislature.

Many of the state's other large school districts, including Brockton, Cambridge, Fall River, and Newton, already have some form of cellphone ban in place, as do dozens of other states. Massachusetts is one of only a handful remaining without a baseline policy.

The Boston ban will require approval from the mayor-appointed School Committee, which plans to vote on it in January. The City Council passed a resolution last year supporting such a prohibition.

PHONES, Page A7

BPS worker accused of rape at barracks on Vineyard

By John R. Ellement, Jeremiah Manion, Christopher Huffaker, and Lea Skene
GLOBE STAFF

A Boston Public Schools security official has been charged with raping a woman he met at a bar and then brought back to the State Police barracks on Martha's Vineyard, where he was staying with a trooper friend in August, according to court testimony.

The woman was found naked on the side of a nearby road outside the barracks the morning of Aug. 15, screaming for help, according to prosecutors.

Edward J. Brown, 27, was arrested Friday at Boston Latin Academy in Boston, according to a recording of his arraignment, which was held Tuesday. Arresting officers also found what they suspect is cocaine in his possession, prosecutors said.

Brown pleaded not guilty to rape at his arraignment in Edgartown District Court, according to the recording, which the Globe obtained Wednesday. He will face the cocaine charge at a later date, authorities said.

An assistant director of security, Brown was

RAPE, Page A10

Let's be seasonable

Thursday: Cooler, rain late. High 59-64. Low 47-52.

Friday: Showers early. High 67-72. Low 46-51.

High tide: 2:55 a.m., 2:59 p.m.

Sunrise: 6:57 Sunset: 6:02

Weather and Comics, D5-6.

VOL. 310, NO. 107
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Suggested retail price
$4.00

0 947725 41410

The Justice Department has threatened California with possible legal action over what it says are noncitizens who allegedly have received mail ballots for the midterm elections. **A2.**

Treatments for lung cancer have been improving in the last few years, but the pope's prognosis is unclear. **A3.**

The Motor Mart Garage, a century-old Art Deco structure on the border of Bay Village and Back Bay, has sold at a massive discount. **D1.**

New York City plans to ban horse-drawn carriages from Central Park, ending their more than 150-year run as an iconic tourist attraction. **A2.**

"Girls," which left the air in 2017, will return for a five-episode encore, HBO said. **B6.**

They're killing us without kindness

Are people really getting ruder? WHO WANTS TO KNOW??!

BETH TEITELL

When Boston stand-up comedian Will Noonan grabs the mic and looks out at the crowd, he can spot the person who's going to become a problem before even they are aware of it.

"They've brought the bad energy with them," Noonan said. "You can see it. Their eyes are darting around looking around for something to set them off."

I wanted to talk with Noonan in the wake of yet another rude customer story — in this case at an ice cream parlor in Blackstone, where one person "lost it" after mistakenly being overcharged by 15 cents, and the owners got so fed up with regularly occurring angry episodes that they let loose on Facebook with a screed that made it all the way to the New York Post.

"STOP YELLING AT MY [EXPLETIVE] EMPLOYEES," it read.

The way things are going, it seems likely that soon everyone will be unhinged — we'll all be ice cream hecklers — and I

RUDENESS, Page A7



ILLUSTRATION BY LUIS G. RENDON/GLOBE STAFF; ADOBE